WENZHOU-KEAN
UNIVERSITY

GMBA 5885 W04 Group Project Instructions

AI-Driven Information Systems Innovation

Overview

The goal of this group project is to help you understand how Management Information Systems (MIS) work in real business practice. You should demonstrate your understanding of *the concepts, frameworks, and analytical tools* learned in this course to analyze real-world MIS.

Building on that foundation, this group project places a special emphasize on artificial intelligence (AI) and its strategic role in modern information systems. Each group will **(a)** analyze a real company, evaluate how its existing information systems support its business strategy, **(b)** and then propose AI-driven innovations that either:

- **Embed AI** into the company's current information system to enhance decision-making, operational efficiency, or customer experience, **or**
- **Develop a new AI solution** that could **transform or replace** the existing information system.

Through this project, you will connect theory to practice, integrate strategic and technological perspectives, and explore how AI + MIS can create sustainable business value and competitive advantages.

Timeline of Group Project

Stage	Deliverables	Deadline
Proposal (20%)	4-5 pages, 12-point font, 1.5-line spacing	Dec 6, 23:59
Presentation (20%)	20mins Presentation + 5mins Q&A	Dec 14, Morning
Final Report (20%)	10-12 pages, 12-point font, 1.5-line spacing	Dec 18, 23:59

Stage 1: Proposal (20%) – Due Dec 6, 23:59

Goal

Conduct a strategic and information-system analysis of a real company to identify one focal information system for deeper study in later stages.

Company Selection

Each group should select a target company that you are familiar with or interested in analyzing. A company where you currently work or have worked/interned is recommended.

Note

Most companies provide a variety of products or services supported by several information systems. For this project:

- Focus your strategic analysis (e.g., Five-Force Analysis, Value Chain Analysis, Resource-Based View) on the company's **primary** product or service.
- In the information systems analysis, concentrate on the information system that supports the company's primary value-generating activities rather than secondary or support functions.

Outside Information

You are encouraged to gather relevant background data to strengthen your analysis. Useful resources include:

- Online research about the company's background
- Library resources such as magazines, trade publications, and academic journals
- The company's annual report and public filings

Deliverables **(4–5 pages excluding reference, 12-point font, 1.5-line spacing)**

Please organize your proposal using the following structure:

1. **Introduction:** Provide a concise overview of the company: name, organizational structure, and primary business activities.

2. **Strategic Analysis:** 1) *Five-Force Analysis:* focus on the company's **primary** product or service, not all their products/service 2) *Value Chain Analysis:* what are the company's unique primary value-generating activities and supportive activities? 3) *Resource-Based View:* what assets does this company have? Any of them is rare and hard to imitate? 4) *Strategy Alignment:* what is the company's business strategy? How it drives the company's organizational strategy and information system strategy?

3. **Information System Analysis:** Among all information systems used by the company, please *pick one that is used to support the company's* ***primary*** *value-generating activity*, and explain 1) the primary functional modules of that information system used in this company, 2) what is the motivation for using this information system, 3) what is the result? can this information system help this company to achieve their business strategy? why or why not?

4. **Challenges:** 1) *Problem Identification:* In using/implementing this information system, what are the problems/difficulties that this company encountered? Not management problem, please focus on information systems problem 2) *Problem Solution:* provide your initial ideas on how these problems might be addressed based on your understanding.

5. **References:** Use APA reference format for all references, including books, academic journals, and credible online resources.

Evaluation Criteria

- Depth and logic of strategic and IS analysis
- Clarity of problem identification and relevance to the firm's context
- Coherence and writing quality

Stage 2: Presentation (20%) – Dec 14, Morning

Goal

Present the findings from your Stage 1 proposal and further develop an **AI-driven innovation** that aims to **improve or transform** the information system and challenges analyzed in Stage 1.

Deliverables (20mins presentation + 5mins Q&A)

1. **Recap:** Key insights from Stage 1 (Five Forces, Value Chain, RBV, and IS analysis).
2. **AI Innovation Proposal:**
    - Define the **AI opportunity** tied to the business and IS challenge.
    - Describe your proposed **AI-driven solution**, including
        - Appropriate, realistic AI method/module/application: predictive analytics, recommendation engine, NLP Chabot, generative AI assistant, automation, etc.
        - How the AI solution works: data sources, model logic, system workflow, outputs, expected business value (**this should be the main focus**).
        - Integration approach: AI embedded into existing IS or development of a new AI-enabled system.

- Outline an implementation plan that **briefly covers** key steps, stakeholders, timeline, and resource needs, with **greater emphasize on potential risk and relevant ethical or social concern**.

Evaluation Criteria

- Strength and originality of the AI-driven innovation
- Logical connection between Stage 1 analysis and proposed AI solution
- Feasibility, strategic fit, and clarity of presentation

Stage 3: Final Report (20%) – Dec 18, 23:59

Goal

Deliver an integrated written report combining insights from Stage 1 (analysis) and Stage 2 (AI innovation) into a cohesive strategic proposal.

Deliverables (10–12 pages excluding references, 12-point font, 1.5-line spacing)

1. Executive summary
2. Company background
3. Strategic analysis of business, information systems (Five Forces, Value Chain, RBV)
4. Challenges and problem definition (1-5 adapted from Stage 1)
5. Proposed AI-driven innovation
    - Technology overview and system architecture
    - Integration plan with existing IS or design of a new AI system
    - Expected business value and strategic impact
    - Implementation roadmap and risk management
6. Ethical and governance considerations (AI ethics, data privacy, bias, etc.) (6-8 adapted from Stage 2)
7. Conclusion and managerial implications
8. References (APA format)

Evaluation Criteria

- Integration of Stages 1 and 2 into a coherent narrative
- Analytical depth and realism of the AI solution
- Application of MIS frameworks and AI concepts
- Report organization, clarity, and academic integrity

AI Use Policy

- Ensure that your Turnitin plagiarism review report shows a **similarity rate below 15%**.
- Please indicate **whether and how** you use AI to finish your work (e.g., proposal, presentation, final report.)